

BRIEFING NOTE

Applicant: Ifeanyi Ephraim Awunor

Degree Background: B.A. & M.A. Theatre Arts

Research Field: Cultural History / Anthropology

Region: Nigeria (West Africa)

Project Summary:

This PhD project examines the cultural formation of the Ubulubu migrant community in southern Nigeria, focusing on migration history, ritual performance, and traditional authority. Originating from Owo (Yoruba region) and now settled in an Igbo-speaking area, the Ubulubu have developed a culturally hybrid system encompassing language, masquerade, festival, and rotational kingship. The research treats ritual performance as a historical archive through which migration and authority are remembered and negotiated.

Methodology

- Historical analysis
- Ethnographic fieldwork
- Performance studies

Supervisory Fit

- Migration studies
- Ritual and religion
- African cultural history